

CONCEPT PAPER — TWO OF THREE

One system, from the free room to the numbered invoice.

A booking system that a lodge operates itself: an occupancy calendar that tells the truth, seasons and per-person tariffs the way this market actually quotes them, walk-in bookings taken at the desk, a folio on every stay, and invoices with no gaps in the numbering. Built on the same model every channel manager in Southern Africa already speaks, so connecting one is a mapping rather than a translation.

HOW TO READ THE STATUS MARKS

RUNNING

in production today

BUILT

built and tested, never yet run with a live partner or real money

DESIGNED

decided, not built

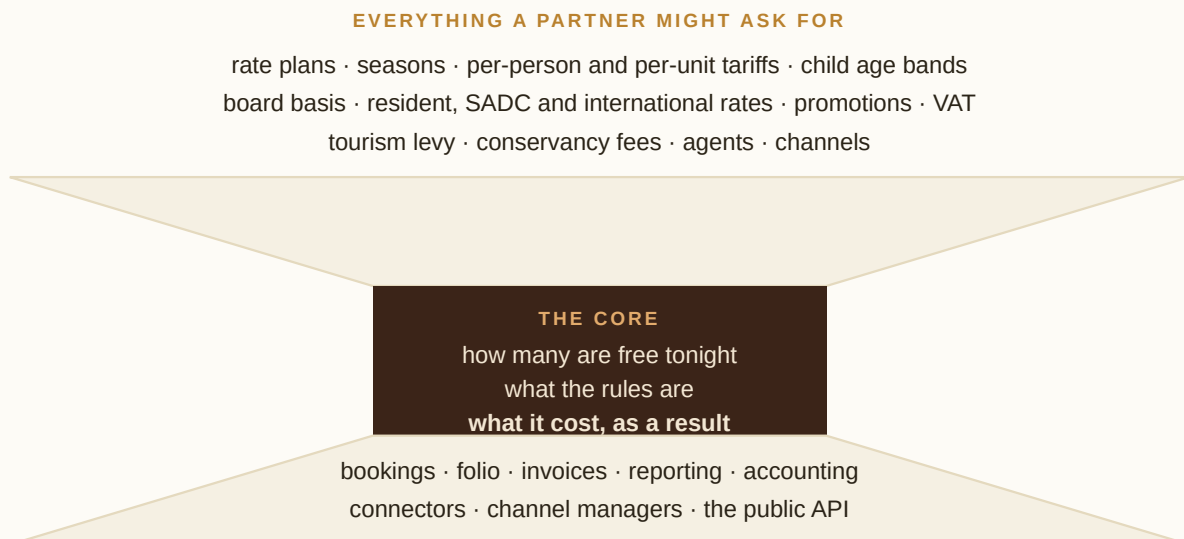
The difference between the second mark and the third is the whole honesty of this paper.





Model anything a lodge asks for, and still be operable by a receptionist

The usual way of resolving that is to make everything configurable — a rules engine, prices as formulas, ninety settings — which reliably produces a system nobody can operate. We went the other way: a very small core that never changes, all the variety pushed to the edges, and the result frozen so nothing downstream has to understand any of it.



The core knows no business models, only their results. Everything above decides what a night costs; everything below reads a number already decided and written down — which is what lets us say yes to an unusual tariff without the rest of the system paying for it.

WHAT "WE CAN DO THAT" MEANS TECHNICALLY

A partner with a pricing scheme we have not seen before is **one new class** — no change to the calendar or to availability, no database migration, nothing to re-test downstream. Each scheme is a pure calculation, so it can be checked against a table of worked examples. Without that, "we support everything" would mean "we can verify nothing".

BOOKING SYSTEM OR FULL PMS — CHOSEN AT SETUP

RUNNING

Booking only

Sell the room, take the request, keep the calendar, price the season, raise the invoice. For a property that runs its front desk somewhere else and does not want a second one.

Full, with the desk

Additionally the working day: the arrivals and departures board and the movements a receptionist performs between breakfast and lunch. *One rule keeps this from becoming two products — the mode decides what a partner sees, never how anything is recorded.*



One screen that answers the only question a lodge asks all day

Unit types down, nights across, and in every cell the two numbers that matter: how many are free, and what one costs tonight. Stays and blocks are drawn on top as bars, so "sold out" and "taken off sale" are visibly different rather than the same empty square.

	Mon 14	Tue 15	Wed 16	Thu 17	Fri 18
Standard chalet 6 units	4 N\$ 2 100	2 Meyer · 2 rooms · dinner, bed & breakfast	2	3	5 N\$ 2 100
Family chalet 2 units	1 min 2 nights	0 sold out	0 sold out	1 N\$ 3 600	2 N\$ 3 200
Campsite 8 pitches	8 N\$ 380	8 N\$ 380	Off sale — ablutions rebuilt		

Free units and the rate in every cell · restrictions as quiet markers · off sale drawn as a hatch, so it survives a monochrome print

A hatch rather than a colour, so "off sale" survives a photocopier and a colour-blind reader — and a block for maintenance or owner use is counted apart from sales, so an occupancy figure never reports a closed room as sold. **Clicking a free cell opens a booking with that unit and that night already filled in; a night with nothing left is inert**, because a form that could only refuse is a dead end.

THE LAST ROOM, AND TWO PEOPLE WANTING IT

Availability is a counter moved by the database itself, not a number the application reads, thinks about and writes back. Of two bookings racing for the last chalet, **one changes a row and the other changes nothing** — and finds out immediately, rather than at check-in. Overbooking is almost always this exact race, unhandled.

WHAT THE CALENDAR CARRIES

RUNNING

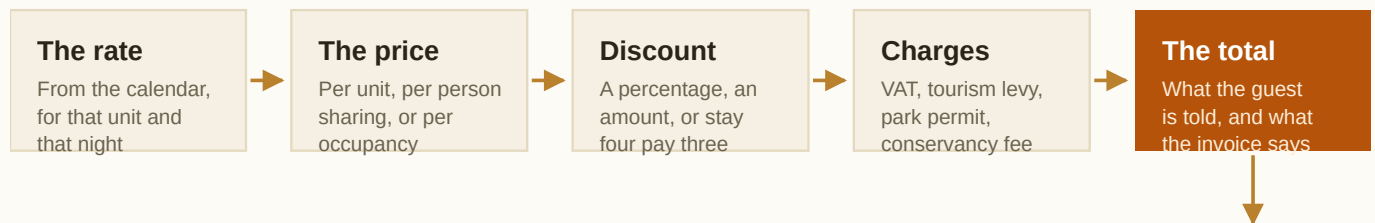
Inventory and rate per night	One row per unit type per night carrying units, rate and stay rules. Nothing is written to say "unchanged" — a missing night follows the unit's default, which is what keeps a season cheap to set.
Stay restrictions	Minimum stay, closed to arrival, closed to departure — the industry's three, refused with the unit and the date named rather than as "unavailable".
Seasons, set in one pass	A date range, optionally narrowed to certain weekdays. An empty field means "leave this alone", so a weekend surcharge cannot silently clear a minimum stay.
Time inside a day	A unit may run a timetable, so a seat on an 08:00 departure is counted like a bed on a night. Properties that sell only nights never see it.



Priced the way this market actually quotes

Namibian lodges price per person per night sharing, with a single supplement, children in age bands, and dinner-bed-and-breakfast closer to the rule than the exception. Campsites and self-catering units price per unit. A state operator publishes resident, SADC and international tariffs side by side. A system with one price per night cannot represent any of that — so this one does not have one.

ONE DIRECTION ONLY — NOTHING DOWNSTREAM REACHES BACK



FROZEN ONTO THE BOOKING, NIGHT BY NIGHT

The amount per night, the rate plan's name, the board basis, every charge and its basis — recorded as they were at the moment the stay was written, and never recomputed.

A lodge raising its rate tomorrow does not make yesterday's booking more expensive. A VAT change in March leaves February's invoices exactly as they were. A rate plan renamed in the winter does not rewrite what the summer sold.

Charges apply **to** a finished price and can never reach back into how it was calculated — so no product ever ends up knowing "15% VAT plus a 2% levy". An included charge is **extracted** rather than added, which is a different sum: 15% of 3 000 is 450, but the VAT already inside 3 000 is 391.30.

THE PIECES A LODGE SETS UP

RUNNING

Rate plans

The product being sold: board basis, cancellation terms, and who it is for — public, resident, SADC, agent. The industry's own vocabulary, not ours.

Three pricing modes

Per unit, per occupancy, or per person sharing with a single supplement. Which one applies is a property of the rate plan, so one lodge can sell both.

Child age bands

Set per property rather than as a constant, because every lodge draws the lines somewhere different. They apply the same way under all three modes.

Promotions

Percentage, amount or free nights. They never stack, a typed code beats a larger public offer, and a code that does not work refuses the booking rather than quietly charging full price.

Taxes and levies

Four bases — a percentage, per person per night, per room per night, or once per booking — each either included in the rate or added on top.

Refusals a human can act on

"Only one of two standard chalets is free on 14 September", not "unavailable". A plan that prices by guests will not price a booking that names none.



A booking system that cannot say whether a stay has been paid is not one

Until August 2026 this one carried what a stay *owed* and nothing about what had arrived. It now has both sides: a folio on every stay, one record per movement of money whatever the method, and a real invoice rather than a PDF export.

THE FOLIO — ONE STAY, BOTH SIDES

What the stay owes

3 nights, priced night by night
Extras posted to the stay
VAT and tourism levy, on their own lines
Total

What has arrived

Deposit · card · cleared
Balance · cash at the desk · recorded
Refund · bank transfer · negative
Paid, and what is left

The invoice

Numbered without gaps, per property, per year · the lines frozen as issued · corrected only by a credit note

Cash over the counter, a bank transfer, a card at the desk and an online payment are the same record with a different method — which is why the ledger was built once and works for a lodge with no card facility at all.

Recorded is not the same as cleared. A transfer a guest says they have sent and a payment a gateway has confirmed are not the same certainty, and the record says which — but a desk handed cash is not waiting for a bank, so a recorded payment counts against the balance immediately.

NOTHING IS EVER EDITED. THIS IS THE RULE THE REST HANGS OFF.

A payment entered wrongly is **reversed** — a negative line pointing back at the one it corrects, with both lines kept — and then entered again. A refund is a negative payment on the same folio. Neither is a deletion, because "we refunded N\$ 2 400 on 14 September" is a fact somebody may have to defend a year later, and **"did we give that money back, or did we never have it?" has two different answers to an accountant.**

WHY THE INVOICE NUMBERING IS WORTH A PARAGRAPH

Invoice numbers are taken from a locked counter inside the transaction that issues them. The two obvious alternatives are both wrong, and wrong invisibly: counting the highest number and adding one hands two simultaneous check-outs the same number, and a database auto-increment does not give a number back when a transaction rolls back.

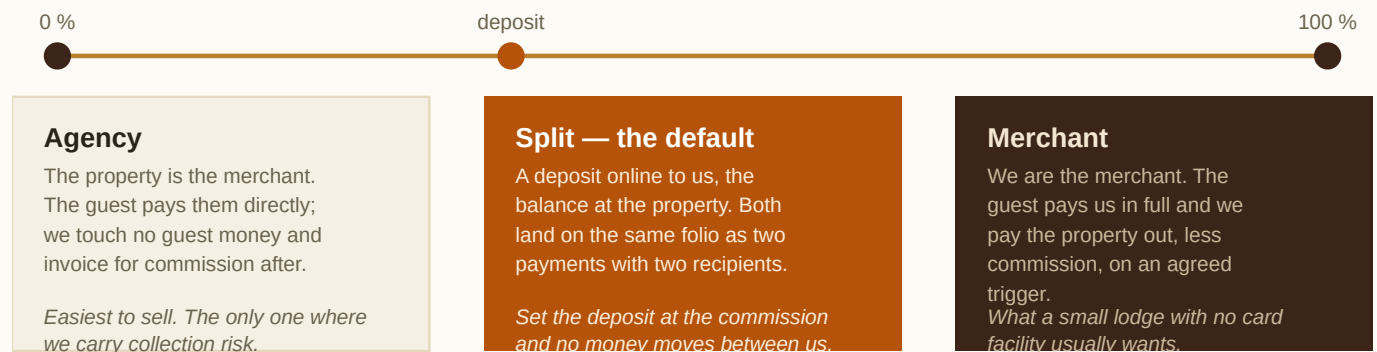
A hole in the run is the first thing an auditor asks about, and the innocent and the fraudulent explanations look identical from the outside. An issued invoice cannot be changed at all — the only correction is a credit note referencing it, with every line negated so the VAT reversal is visible rather than a lump sum.



Three ways to be paid, and the partner picks

Most platforms insist on one. We offer the industry's three, because partners genuinely want different things and insisting would cost us the ones who want the other. Recording money is identical in all three — the folio, the payments, the invoice and the commission are the same — so only the direction and timing of the net transfer change.

ONE NUMBER PICKS THE MODEL — THE SHARE OF THE FOLIO WE COLLECT UP FRONT



There is deliberately no "settlement model" setting anywhere. The model is read off the deposit share, every time, so a partner can never end up configured as "merchant model, and we collect nothing" — a contradiction that is only possible if you store the answer twice.

A stay resolves its model from **its own deposit rate as it was when the booking was taken**, not the property's current one — so a statement about last season still adds up after a renegotiation.

WHO SETS WHICH NUMBER

Commission is ours RUNNING	Set by us, adjustable per partner and per property, and never an editable field in the partner panel — though a partner can always see what they pay. Modelled deliberately below what the international portals charge.
The deposit is the partner's RUNNING	They choose it for their own property, within a range we allow. A floor follows the commission rate, because that is the point where nothing has to move between us at all.
Zero is a permission, not a number RUNNING	Collecting nothing means we invoice for commission and carry the risk of it going unpaid, so it is unlocked per partner rather than typed. Both panels state, live, which model the current deposit means.
Both rates frozen at booking RUNNING	The rate and the amount, on the stay. "5% of what?" is the first thing a partner asks, and the base is not reconstructable once the charges have moved.
Commission never on tax RUNNING	The base is the stay before VAT and the tourism levy. Charging commission on the government's money is indefensible in front of an operator.
Payouts and statements DESIGNED	Not built. What is owed on a single stay, and in which direction, is answered. The run that aggregates it, the statement a partner reads, and the record of a transfer having happened are not — they want real money to have moved first.



What a lodge does with it between breakfast and lunch

Walk-in and telephone bookings

RUNNING

Several unit types at once under one guest, priced from the calendar night by night, with an override that is recorded as a discrepancy rather than hidden.

The morning board

RUNNING

Arrivals, departures and who is in house for one date, printable, with what is outstanding and the passenger list for a departure — because that sheet leaves the office.

Moving a guest through the day

RUNNING

Due in, in house, checked out, no show; cancelling puts the rooms back on sale. The buttons are generated from what the system will actually allow, so no screen offers a move that would be refused.

An unpaid list

RUNNING

Everything at the property that is not square, soonest arrival first. A cancelled stay with a forfeited deposit appears there — exactly the case a system without a folio gets wrong.

A guest record

RUNNING

Per property, matched on the account first and the email second, with a comment log. A group's twenty camps share their guests; another lodge keeps its own record of the same person.

Several properties, one login

RUNNING

Switched from the top bar, remembered per person. Built for an operator with twenty camps under one organisation, not retrofitted for one.

Desk mode

RUNNING

A button that fills a reception screen with the calendar and nothing else. Works on a tablet that will not give an application full screen at all.

Online payment

BUILT

Deposit or balance, pay, decline, abandon and refund, end to end — against a gateway that operates in Namibia and settles in Namibian dollars. See the limits opposite.

Room-level assignment

DESIGNED

Not built. The system holds unit types and quantities, never a named room. A lodge that assigns physical rooms needs this, and it is the first thing a real desk is likely to ask for.

WHAT WE DO NOT CLAIM

No connector has ever run against a real partner account. Adapters exist for the dominant lodge PMS in this market, for the common channel manager, for the Namibian-specific package, and for a content-only itinerary system — all written against documented behaviour. We say "designed to connect to". The first real integration will turn up surprises, and we would rather say so now.

No merchant account has ever settled a real transaction. The whole payment flow is built and demonstrable, and the demonstration provider needs no account and no internet — but nothing you see move is real money. "Built to settle in Namibian dollars" is the claim. "We take card payments" is not.

Payouts and partner statements do not exist, no housekeeping or tax reporting exists, and there is no channel synchronisation, no calendar feed and no live link to any other system. There is no button anywhere that hints at one, because a disabled button is a claim.

And no volume figures. No partner is live, so there is no uptime record, no booking count and no reference customer to name.



A pilot on one property, alongside whatever you run today

We would rather be judged on a working system than on a document. So the ask is deliberately small, and nothing about it requires switching anything off.

1

See it on your own property

We set your lodge up on example bookings before the meeting and show it running. Real software, made-up data — and every screen says so.

2

Agree the measures

What would make this a success and how it gets counted, in writing, before a line of work is done.

3

One property, one season

We enter the units and the rates, train whoever takes the bookings, and run alongside what you use today. Your business never depends on us alone.

4

Then decide

Look at what actually happened and extend it, change it, or stop. Nothing owed beyond the season.

TWO THINGS WORTH KNOWING BEFORE YOU AGREE TO ANYTHING

Your data stays yours and can be exported in full at any time. There is no lock-in beyond a notice period we agree in writing.

Running two systems for the same rooms will drift, and pretending otherwise is how pilots fail. Either you give us a fixed allotment of rooms per date that we may sell without asking — which the calendar already expresses exactly, with a release deadline back to you — or we check with you by hand, which is honest and which we already do. What we will not do is call either of those an integration.

BUILT AND OPERATED HERE

Same country, same time zone

On site within a day, and built for the connections your camps actually have rather than for a fibre line in Europe. We host it, back it up nightly to encrypted off-site storage, and answer the phone.

Standards, not inventions

The availability, rate and inventory model is the one every channel manager in this market already speaks, so connecting one later is a mapping. Where we deviate, it is written down and argued.

One of four papers. The others: *The whole picture* — three product lines on one platform, and what is not built — plus *Kaia Trip Planning* and *Websites*.

Let us set up one of your camps

On example bookings, before you decide anything — an hour of your time and you can see your own property priced, sold, checked in, paid and invoiced. The ask after that is one property and one season.



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